

Kepler discovered that the planets sweep out ellipses, not circles, with the Sun sitting at one focus rather than at the centre. Newton now poses the crowning question of Book I: what force law actually PRODUCES such an orbit? The two foci S and H lie on the major axis, and S is the force centre while H is the empty focus. Drawing the radius SP from the force to the body P , we measure force by the Prop. VI apparatus and will find it varies as $1/SP^2$.